

Wednesday, September 14

The morning went smoothly, except that Peter felt so sick that we kept him home. Augusta was ready for the kids at 8. I started the Mazda and took it to school. Cheryl left soon after. Things are getting hectic. I got a letter from one of last year's students. She was concerned that I had split her away from her friends. "Boone the Bonehead" got in trouble for harassing a little St. Augustine girl yesterday evening. I went directly to a Language Arts meeting at Alvin Buckwold.

When I arrived home by 5 the house was empty, or so I thought. Then I heard Matthew in Peter's bedroom. I found Cheryl grinning at Matthew with drapes pulled over his head. Peter was lying on his side with his hands pressed into his eyes. Trouble waking up.

Cheryl had the boys out this afternoon. Peter's glasses were exchanged for plastic spring-loaded arms. We expect they will look much better than his old pair.

Cheryl brought some mealworms home and had given one to Peter to put in a small jar. He said, "Maybe I could take one to kindergarten." He hesitated and added, "Oh, but I don't suppose they let kids bring creatures into school." After a few moments he brought up the topic of totem poles. This had been a subject on Sesame Street. A car on the street got him started.

"I know where that car is from."

"Oh," said Cheryl, "where?"

"B.C."

"That's right. How do you know?"

"They have blue license plates. Do you know what else they have there? Totem poles."

"What are those, Peter?"

"Tall poles with different animals carved with knives, like birds and monsters. The indians made them."

Later, in his bedroom, Peter was talking about winter. "And don't you break the ice wrinkles off the roof in the winter, okay Mom? I want to play with them."

Matthew has been tottering around like Charlie Chaplin. He reaches for a lowered hand and pulls it along the hallway, watching feet, matching his own step with them. While eating supper Matthew sat in a box and pushed out all the sides. I had him on his back, nosing him under the chin. He laughs and tries to push up with his hands and feet. Cheryl and I were kissing. He came from the hallway and tried to push me back while pulling on Cheryl's hand to show he wanted to be picked up. Which Cheryl did. But then she reached for me and the three of us stood together. This still wasn't good enough. When we kissed again he pushed my head back, and with an open mouth he tried to draw Cheryl's head his way.

The three of them went to Peter's choir practise. Matthew and Cheryl stayed in the nursery. Peter had set the conditions before leaving: "If it's too hard then I won't do anything. If it's fun then I will."

Once home he practised cello in the basement. Peter is getting back both his form and his interest. He comes up the stairs, cheerful and ready for bed.

We read Tuck. He likes it much better now. "It doesn't give me bad dreams." He does remember the heroes of the Book of Three with some fondness.

After leaving Peter I followed as Matthew walked like a duck into his room. Then he went into Peter's room. They giggled together. Matthew showed up briefly in the hallway, then returned to Peter. Peter pulled him into the bed. Shortly after, Matthew went to bed. After leaning against me and rubbing my stomach he lay down, sighed and went to sleep.

Guitar lessons start again on Wednesday 4 pm.

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Cheryl offered Peter candy this afternoon. They stood at the bins until he decided on one lemon candy for a nickel. He kept it in his back pocket.

"Augusta doesn't understand me," he said yesterday.

"Why do you say that Peter," I asked.

"She doesn't seem to hear what I say."

It was left that way until today when I asked him again how Augusta was. "Oh fine, she understands me now."

"Good, what happened?"

"She listens to me. She doesn't say 'what' after everything I say."